

01 / START WITH A CLEAR PLAN

Is This Guide for You?

This project is for a couple, relative, or friend arranging flowers for 6-12 reception tables with help from a small team. You do not need floral-design experience. You do need permission to use the materials at the venue, a place to work, and a realistic plan for keeping and moving the flowers.

You will choose one recipe, make a full sample table, calculate your order, and write instructions someone else can follow. The aim is repeatable table arrangements that leave room for dinner and conversation.

Start by naming a flower lead. This person holds the plan, approves changes, and checks that each stage is complete. The lead should not be someone whose wedding-day commitments prevent them from answering a delivery or setup question.

A workable division of responsibility has four functions: planning and purchasing, preparation and assembly, transport, and installation. One person may cover more than one function, but every function needs an owner and backup.

Before buying for all tables, answer this question: "Who will physically complete this task, where will they do it, and how will we know it worked?" If the answer is missing, write it on Worksheet 1, page 41, as an unresolved condition.



AI-generated aesthetic illustration / Use written quantities for planning.

02 / CHOOSE YOUR FLOWERS

White Carnation: Build One Vase

- 1 Place the approved vase on the protected work surface. Fill using the sample's accepted water level and the care plan on page 30. Leave the outside dry.
- 2 Hold the first prepared carnation alongside the vase. Choose a head position that leaves room for the second head and fits your seated-view test. Mark your intended cut by observation, not by a universal flower-to-vase ratio.
- 3 Make the cut and place the first stem into the vase. Check where its cut end sits. It must remain within the water throughout the planned checking interval.
- 4 Size the second stem beside the first. A modest difference in height can keep the heads from pressing together, but neither head should dominate the vase or pull it off balance.
- 5 Insert the second stem gently. If the neck grips the pair tightly or either stem must be forced, stop and reconsider the material combination.
- 6 Turn the vase on the work surface and view it from several directions. Make small changes to stem position before shortening again. Cutting is irreversible.
- 7 Repeat with the remaining three vases. Place all four in the approved table layout and compare the group.

Count again: two stems per vase, eight per table. Record the pilot's actual total arrangement height and cut lengths on Worksheet 4.

05 / PRINTABLE PLANNING SHEETS

Worksheet 2: Vase and Stem Calculation

Use pages 23-25. Count stems, not blooms. Complete one species column at a time.

Event:	Tables T:	Recipe:
Vases in use = $T \times 4$:	Separate spare-vase allowance:	
Total event vases to obtain:	Pilot vases already available / usable:	

Field	Carnations / white standard	Alstroemeria / pink
Stems per table for chosen recipe		
Event stems used $U = T \times \text{species rate}$		
Reserve rate r (initial candidate: 0.20)		
Reason for rate if revised		
Required $A = \text{round UP}[U \times (1+r)]$		
Reserve allocation $A-U$		
Confirmed stems per bunch B		
Bunches $N = \text{round UP}[A \div B]$		
Actual purchase $P = N \times B$		
Bunch-rounding surplus $P-A$		
Usable event stems received		
Rejected stems at receipt		
Later observed losses (not receipt rejects)		
Replacement stems received		
Actual stems installed		
Healthy stems unused after installation		
Other use / discrepancy, explain below		

Total planned event stems = $T \times 8$:

Sum of planned species use matches? () Yes () No

Pilot stems purchased separately:

Discrepancy / replacement record:

Reconcile receipts and replacements against rejects, later losses, installed stems, healthy unused stems, and other documented use. Do not count a rejected stem twice.

Calculated by / date:

Checked independently by / date: